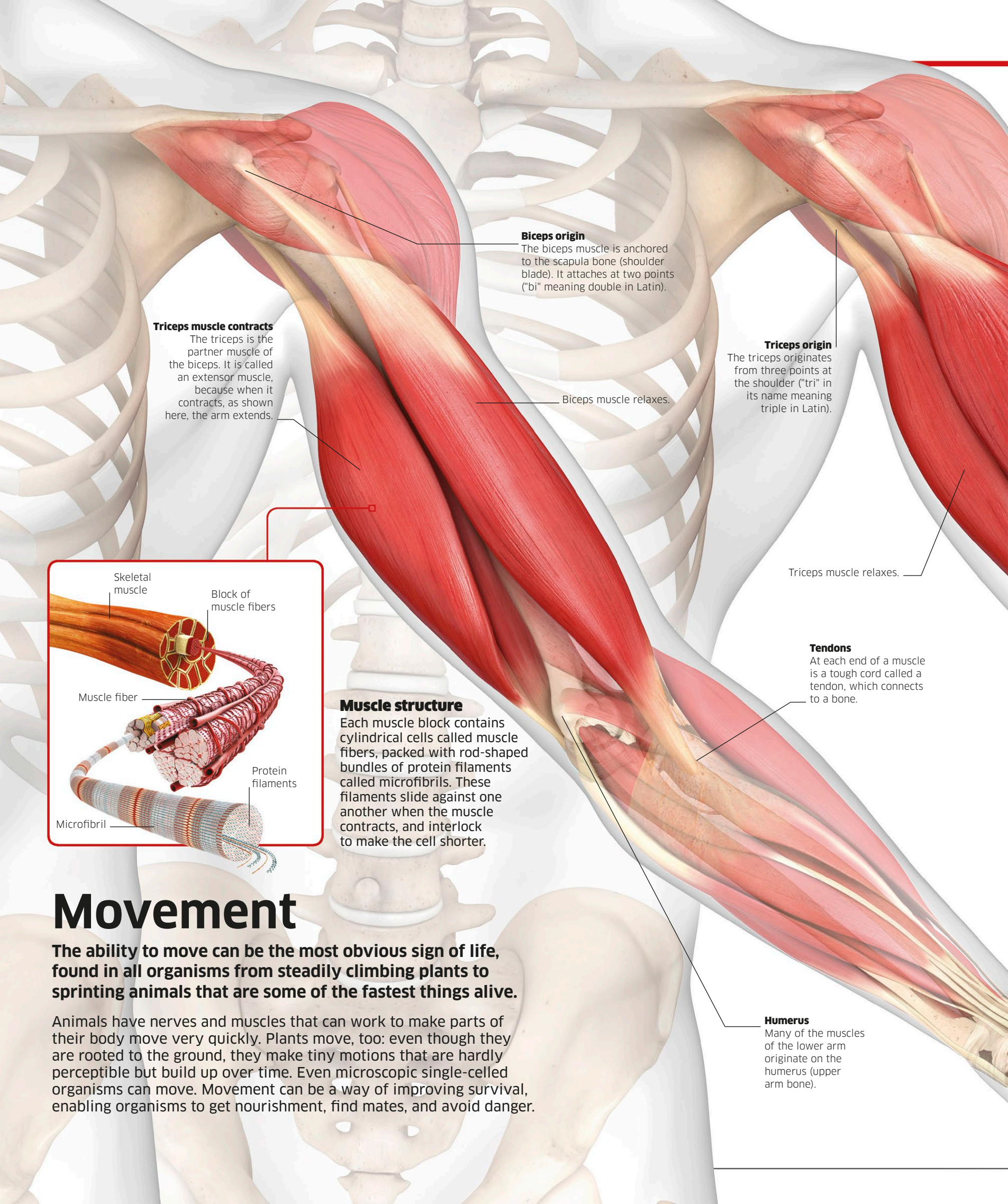




Biceps origin

The biceps muscle is anchored to the scapula bone (shoulder blade). It attaches at two points ("bi" meaning double in Latin).

Triceps muscle contracts

The triceps is the partner muscle of the biceps. It is called an extensor muscle, because when it contracts, as shown here, the arm extends.

Triceps origin

The triceps originates from three points at the shoulder ("tri" in its name meaning triple in Latin).

Biceps muscle relaxes.

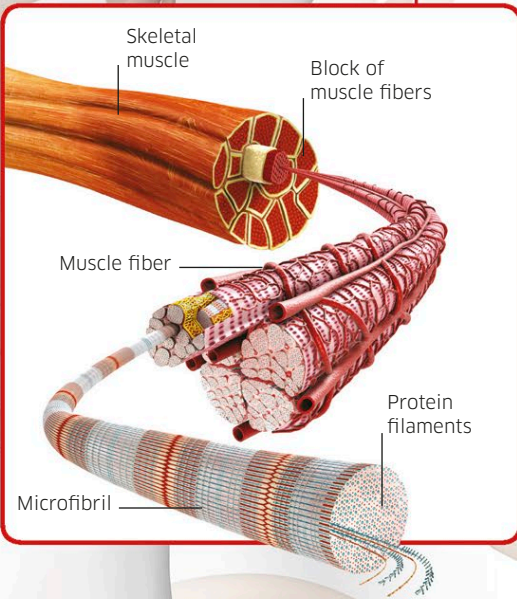
Triceps muscle relaxes.

Tendons

At each end of a muscle is a tough cord called a tendon, which connects to a bone.

Muscle structure

Each muscle block contains cylindrical cells called muscle fibers, packed with rod-shaped bundles of protein filaments called microfibrils. These filaments slide against one another when the muscle contracts, and interlock to make the cell shorter.



Movement

The ability to move can be the most obvious sign of life, found in all organisms from steadily climbing plants to sprinting animals that are some of the fastest things alive.

Animals have nerves and muscles that can work to make parts of their body move very quickly. Plants move, too: even though they are rooted to the ground, they make tiny motions that are hardly perceptible but build up over time. Even microscopic single-celled organisms can move. Movement can be a way of improving survival, enabling organisms to get nourishment, find mates, and avoid danger.

Humerus

Many of the muscles of the lower arm originate on the humerus (upper arm bone).